

Company: **Barclays**
Job Profile: **Summer Intern 2025**
Offer Type: **Internship Only**
Internship Stipend: **75000/month**
Location: **Pune Maharashtra**
Process Date: **12/09/2024**

Placement Process:

1. **Online Assessment** (Out of all who appeared, 27 were selected for next round)

This was an online test conducted at college consisting of 14 questions of total marks 100. Among these, one was a coding question with 10 test cases for 50 marks that carried maximum weightage, one was an SQL query question for 10 marks and the rest 12 focused on CS fundamentals with a significant emphasis on DBMS and OOPS.

To prepare for this round, I thoroughly revised the concepts of OOPS, DBMS, CN, OS and DSA. I practiced problems on Codeforces and also participated in many contests.

2. **Technical Interview** (Out of 27 students who appeared, 15 were selected for next round)

The interview lasted for about 30-40 minutes. It started with the interviewer asking me to introduce myself. After hearing my introduction, he focused on my interest in machine learning and asked me to explain what machine learning is. Next, he asked how machine learning actually works and what "data" is. After that he gave me a scenario: "What if some wrong or extreme values are included in the dataset? How would you make sure the machine still gives accurate results?".

After discussing machine learning, the interviewer moved on to DBMS. He gave me a table and asked me to normalize it step by step, explaining how to make the table more efficient by reducing redundancy. He also asked me about DML and DDL commands. Then he asked me one numerical question on all types of join.

Next, we shifted to data structures and problem-solving. He asked me a few questions about linked lists, including how to write code to detect if there's a cycle in a linked list and how to swap two nodes. He also asked how to swap two numbers without using extra variables. There was a pattern-printing question as well, where I had to write code to print a specific design using loops. Toward the end, the interviewer asked about my experience with competitive programming and rating as mentioned on my resume. At the end he asked about Git and GitHub.

For this round, it is important to be thoroughly prepared with your resume and solid in your understanding of computer science fundamentals and DSA.

3. **HR Interview** (Out of 15 students who appeared, 13 were selected for next round)

The interview started with the typical question: “Introduce yourself.” After that, I was asked a series of behavioral and personal questions, including:

- **Tell me about your experience during your last internship, and what challenges did you face?** I shared insights into my previous role, detailing the projects I worked on and the challenges I encountered.
- **What were your learnings from this?** I reflected on the skills I gained and how I tackled the difficulties during my internship.
- **Why do you want to join Barclays as an intern?** I expressed my enthusiasm for the opportunity at Barclays, citing the company’s reputation for innovation and its alignment with my career goals.
- **Can you share an experience where you worked in a team, and there were differences in opinions? How did you resolve the conflict or handle clashes between your views and those of your team members?** I described this from my experience of a mini project.

After these questions, the interviewer shifted focus to more specific topics related to the role. He noted my interest in machine learning but mentioned that the internship might involve work in different domains. They asked if I would be willing to work in another area. He also asked whether I had completed any projects using core languages like C or C++.

Useful Tips:

- Be thorough with your resume. If you've mentioned something, ensure you can provide detailed answers when asked about it. (I got stuck while answering questions about Git and GitHub, and the interviewer advised me to gain deeper knowledge of these tools.)
- Have in-depth knowledge of core subjects like DBMS, OOPS, Operating Systems, and Computer Networks. Utilize online resources like Javatpoint and GeeksforGeeks to strengthen your understanding.
- Practice solving problems on platforms like Codeforces, CodeChef, and LeetCode. Also, participate in coding contests to enhance your ability to solve problems under time constraints.
- For HR interviews, maintain confidence and honesty. It’s helpful to be prepared for common behavioral questions to respond more effectively.
- In both interviews, I initially felt nervous, and the interviewers noticed. During the technical round, I was advised to write down my answers on rough paper before explaining them, which helped organize my thoughts. The interviewer also emphasized the importance of sticking to the basics.